HANDLED

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# City of Detroit bids: what to bid, and who you need to hire

## The short version

| Solicitation | Due | Decision | Why |
|---|---|---|---|
| **RFQ 548013, Window Treatments** (DPD) | **Oct 30, 2026, 12:00 PM** | **Bid** | Small one-time job, lowest price wins, no experience minimum. Quote: `HANDLED_QUOTE_RFQ548013_WINDOW_TREATMENTS_2026-10-23_1422` |
| **RFP 549834, Blight Remediation** (GSD) | **Nov 23, 2026, 5:00 PM** | **Bid as a joint venture** | Core Handled work, but it needs 5 years of experience, which has to come from a partner. Proposal: `HANDLED_PROPOSAL_RFP549834_BLIGHT_REMEDIATION_2026-10-23_1413` |
| **RFP 550148, DDC Facilities Maintenance** (Detroit Detention Center) | **Oct 27, 2026, 3:00 PM** | **Don't bid** | Licensed HVAC, plumbing, electrical and fire-protection work, 5 years in each, master/journeyman licenses, 24/7 emergency response, CJIS clearance. Handled has none of these, and there are 4 days left. |
| **RFP 551200, Bunker Gear Cleaning** (Fire Dept.) | **Nov 6, 2026, 4:00 PM** | **Don't bid** | Requires an existing UL- or Intertek-verified gear-care facility (Verified ISP) with ozone washers and a CO2 cleaning system, LION warranty authorization, and a backup verified facility. Subcontracting the work is banned ("must not utilize third parties"). |

## Rules that apply to every City job

- **Crews must be employees (W-2) or an insured subcontractor's employees.** Every City contract here requires Michigan workers' comp, and most ask for a named roster. Handled's usual 1099 "pro" model doesn't fit; a 1099 worker can't be on your workers' comp policy, and the City can't approve people it can't see on a roster.
- **Background checks for everyone.** DPD and DFD buildings require them; DDC requires CJIS clearance.
- **Hire Detroit residents.** The City gives more points for it, asks how many you'll use, and asks you to sign a Priority Hire Agreement with Detroit at Work (free recruiting help: detroitatwork.com). On construction-type work, Executive Order 2016-2 requires at least 50% of worker hours by Detroit residents.
- **Get CRIO certificates** (Detroit Headquartered, Detroit Resident Business, Detroit Micro Business). They add up to 10 points on RFPs and a 12% price allowance on low-bid RFQs.
- **Price the payroll right:** budget about **1.25–1.35×** the hourly wage for payroll taxes, workers' comp, and general liability insurance. Landscaping and demolition-type work has higher workers' comp rates.

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## 1. Window Treatments (RFQ 548013): 2 people for about 2 days

| Role | How many | Type | Qualifications | Pay (estimate) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lead installer | 1 | W-2 (part-time / per job) or an insured installer subcontractor | Blind and window-treatment installation experience, measuring, own hand and power tools, ladder safety, clean background check | $24–$30/hr |
| Helper | 1 | W-2 (part-time / per job) | Reliable, can lift and carry, ladder-safe, clean background check | $17–$20/hr |

| Role | How many | Type | Qualifications | Pay (estimate) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| You (or an office lead) | — | Owner | Order from the supplier, schedule with DPD, invoice through the City portal | — |

No state trade license is needed for installing blinds. The easiest route: hire a Handled pro who already installs blinds as a **part-time W-2 employee** for this job, so they're on your workers' comp. Or use a blind-installation company as a subcontractor with its own insurance and a certificate naming the City.

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## 2. Blight Remediation (RFP 549834): about 16–20 people

The City requires **at least three 4-person crews** with a named roster, and 24-hour emergency response.

| Role | How many | Type | Licenses / training | Pay (estimate) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Contract / Operations Manager | 1 | W-2 salary | Blight or property-maintenance management experience; OSHA-30 | $65k–$85k/yr |
| Field Supervisor | 2 | W-2 | 3+ years crew supervision; OSHA-30; one with the **MDARD pesticide applicator** license | $28–$34/hr |
| Crew Lead | 3 (+1 surge) | W-2 | OSHA-10; can run mowers, trimmers, chainsaws, stump grinder; **valid driver's license** | $23–$26/hr |
| Laborer | 9–12 | W-2 | OSHA-10 and bloodborne-pathogen (sharps) training, given at hire | $18–$21/hr |
| Equipment Operator / Driver | 1–2 | W-2 | Skid steer / mini excavator experience; **CDL Class B** if you run a dump truck over 26,000 lb | $25–$30/hr |
| Painter / Lead-Safe Lead | 1–2 | W-2 | **EPA RRP Certified Renovator** (1-day course); paint/coatings cert such as NCCER or AMPP | $24–$29/hr |
| Documentation & Billing Coordinator | 1 | W-2 | Photo documentation, Smartsheet, invoicing; can be part of Handled's office team | $20–$25/hr |

**Subcontractors (not employees):** licensed electrician (de-energizing signs and lights), licensed tow and storage company (vehicles), crane company (billboards 3+ stories), medical-waste hauler (needles).

**Company-level certifications:** EPA RRP **Firm** certification (apply now; takes up to 90 days), pollution liability insurance ($1M).

**Where to find them:** your Indeed pipeline (landscapers, demolition and junk-removal workers translate directly), Detroit at Work, and the JV partner's existing crews. The partner's experienced supervisors and operators fill the senior slots; Handled hires and trains the laborers and crew leads.

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## 3. DDC Facilities Maintenance (RFP 550148): why not, and what it would take

The work is licensed building-trades maintenance at the Detroit Detention Center: HVAC, plumbing, electrical, fire alarms and sprinklers, plus 24/7 emergency response (written acknowledgment within 2 hours, on site within 4 hours).

| Role it requires | License / requirement |
|---|---|
| Master or Journeyman Electrician (and the company's Michigan electrical contractor license) | State of Michigan license; 5 years of licensed experience |
| Master or Journeyman Plumber (and mechanical contractor license) | State of Michigan license; 5 years of licensed experience |

| Role it requires | License / requirement |
|---|---|
| HVAC lead technician | **1st Class Refrigeration Operator** license, **EPA Section 608 Universal** certification, 5 years of licensed experience |
| Fire alarm / sprinkler / kitchen-hood suppression technician | NFPA 72, 25, 17A and 80 work; typically NICET-certified and a state-licensed fire-protection contractor |
| 24/7 Project Manager | Available around the clock with full authority |
| 24-hour fire alarm monitoring | A monitoring center (usually a UL-listed central station) |
| Everyone on site | Must pass **CJIS** clearance and Michigan State Police background checks; no phones inside the facility |

The company itself also needs 5 years of experience in each trade and 5 references. This is a job for an established licensed mechanical/electrical contractor.

**What Handled can do instead:** contact licensed mechanical and electrical contractors that bid DDC and offer to be their subcontractor for unlicensed support work: general maintenance, cleaning, hauling, minor repairs. That builds a City track record without needing the trade licenses.

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## 4. Bunker Gear Cleaning (RFP 551200): why not

This contract cleans, inspects and repairs firefighters' protective gear (about 2,400 coats and 2,400 pants a year) under NFPA 1850/1851 and 1855/1857. To bid, a company needs **all** of this already in place:

- A gear-care facility that is a **Verified Independent Service Provider** (UL or Intertek) with a certificate less than 2 years old, plus a **second verified backup facility**
- Industrial washer-extractors with **ozone infusion**, a **CO2 cleaning system** on site (supercritical CO2 within one year), and a hydrostatic tester for moisture barriers
- Third-party verification for Gore and Stedfast moisture-barrier materials, and **LION warranty repair authorization**
- The **PSTrax** PPE tracking module, a 24/7 hotline, an on-site quartermaster, loaner gear stock, and weekly pickup from every station
- 5 years of experience and 2 references; **no third parties allowed**

The staff would be trained ISP technicians, industrial sewing / repair technicians, a quartermaster, drivers and a 24/7 answering service. But the facility and verification come first, and they take a large investment and well over the 2 weeks left. Skip it.

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## What to do this week

1. **Today:** in Bonfire, select Intent to Bid on RFQ 548013 (windows) and RFP 549834 (blight). Start the CRIO certification application.
2. **By Oct 26, noon:** send the window-treatment questions (in the quote file).
3. **By Oct 29:** get two supplier quotes for the blinds; finalize the window price.
4. **Oct 30, before noon:** submit the window quote.
5. **By Nov 6:** sign a joint-venture partner for the blight bid; sign up the Field Supervisor and Painter for MDARD and EPA RRP training; file the EPA RRP Firm application.
6. **By Nov 13:** send the blight questions. **Nov 17, 11 AM:** attend the pre-bid meeting.
7. **Nov 23, before 5 PM:** submit the blight proposal.